

Day 2 — The Tridosha

Module: Ayurveda (Middle) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students name the three doshas, their elemental basis, characteristic qualities, and one observable sign of each.

Materials

- Wall chart of the 3 doshas
- Whiteboard

Vocabulary

- *dosha* — humour, biological energy
- *Vāta* — wind/space dosha
- *Pitta* — fire/water dosha
- *Kapha* — water/earth dosha

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Daily prompt + recall: define Āyurveda and Swasthya.

Core (25 min)

1. **Build the dosha table on the board:**

Dosha	Elements	Qualities	Function	When out of balance
Vāta	air + space	mobile, dry, light, cold, rough	Movement, breath, nervous system	Anxiety, insomnia, dry skin, constipation
Pitta	fire + water	hot, sharp, light, oily, slightly liquid	Digestion, metabolism, vision	Heartburn, irritability, skin inflammation
Kapha	water + earth	heavy, slow, cool, oily, smooth	Structure, immunity, lubrication	Lethargy, congestion, weight gain

2. **Note the connection to Module 2.** The doshas are built from the *pañcabhūta* (five elements). Each dosha is a particular combination of elements + qualities.
3. **Important framing: Everyone has all three doshas.** Your *prakṛti* (constitution) is the proportion you're born with. Your *vikṛti* (current state) is your present balance.

4. Where modern medicine agrees, where it doesn't:

- Modern lifestyle medicine: agrees on regular sleep, balanced meals, moderate exercise.
- Modern circadian biology: agrees on aligning daily activities with body rhythms.
- Modern dosha-as-biomedical-category: **mixed evidence**. Some studies show correlates with body type and metabolism; others don't.

Activity (10 min) — Sign spotting

Students think of one person they know (not themselves). Write 3 observable traits. Try to match to a dosha tilt.

(Stress: NOT diagnostic. Just practice with the framework.)

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 3: *“Tomorrow — your own self-assessment. With caveats.”*

Homework

- Notice tonight: what did you eat? When? How did you feel after? Take notes.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read the Caraka Saṃhitā chapter on dosha (in Wujastyk 2003).
- **Tier down:** Memorise just: Vāta (air+space, movement), Pitta (fire+water, digestion), Kapha (water+earth, structure).

Teacher notes

- Don't push students to “find their type.” The framework is interesting; over-typing is not.
- The “everyone has all three” point is critical. Resist the pop-Ayurveda “you ARE Vāta” framing.

Citation(s) used

- vidya-karana RAG cache `day-02-tridosha.json`.
- Wujastyk (2003) for classical Tridosha exposition.